

23. Laboratory Assessment of Kidney Disease_ Glomerular Filtration Rate, Proteinuria, and Urinalysis · assets 1-9 / 17

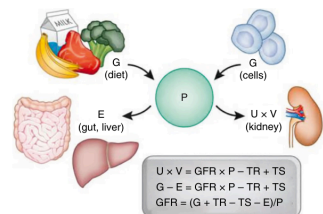


Fig. 23.1 Determinants of the serum level of endogenous filtration markers. The plasma level (P) of an endogenous filtration marker is determined by its generation (G) from cells and diet, extrarenal elimination (E) by gut and liver, and urinary excretion (UV) by the kidney. Urinary excretion is the sum of filtered load (glomerular filtration rate [GFR] $\times$ P) minus reabsorption (TR) plus tubular secretion (TS). In the steady state, generation minus extrarenal elimination equals urinary excretion. By substitution and rearrangement, GFR can be expressed as the ratio of the non- GFR determinants (G , TS , TR , and E) to the plasma level. [Permission granted from *J Am Soc Nephrol* for Stevens LA, Levey AS. Measured GFR as a confirmatory test for estimated GFR. *J Am Soc Nephrol*. 2009;20(11):2305–2313.]

Fig_23_1

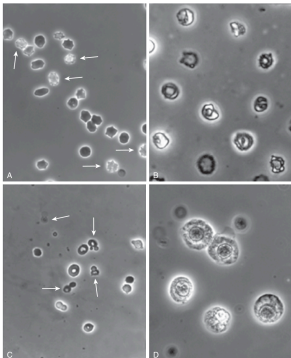


Fig. 23.4 Erythrocytes in urine. (A) Isomorphic erythrocytes, some with a "crenated" appearance (arrows). (B) Different types of dysmorphic erythrocytes. (C) Acanthocytes (arrows). (D) Proximal renal tubule cells. [From Fogazzi GB, Verdesca S, Garigali G. Urinalysis: core curriculum 2008. *Am J Kidney Dis*. 2008;51:1062-1067.]

Fig_23_4

Table 23.1 Clinical applications of laboratory assessment of kidney disease					
Topic/Application	Population	GFR	Proteinuria	Dipstick	Urine microscopy
Significance	All	Overall index of kidney function	Albuminuria as a marker of kidney damage	Initial test for markers of kidney damage	Confirmatory test for markers of kidney damage
Defining kidney disease	AKI	↓ by 0.3 mL/dt/1.73 m ² in 48 hours or by 15% in 7 days, or oliguria <4 hours	NA	NA	NA
	AKD	AH or GFR <60 or GFR by 35% for <3 months	ACR >30 for <3 months	Present for <3 months	Present for <3 months
	CKD	GFR <60 for >3 months	ACR >30 for >3 months	Present for >3 months	Present for >3 months
	CKD	Shape: S defined by changes in Scr, urine output, and initiation of CR	NA	NA	NA
Staging kidney disease (severity)	AKI	As for AKI & AH present	NA & AH present	NA	NA
	AKD	As for CKD & AH absent	As for CKD & AH absent	NA	NA
	CKD	G1-G5 defined by level of GFR	A1-A3 defined by level of albuminuria	NA	NA
Screening special populations/identifying kidney disease in people at increased risk	AKI	Yes	Yes	NA	NA
	AKD	Yes	Yes	NA	NA
	CKD	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
	CKD	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Diagnosing the cause of kidney disease	AKI/AKD/CKD	Yes	NA	NA	NA
	AKI/AKD/CKD	Yes	NA	NA	NA
Assessing progression of kidney disease	AKI/AKD/CKD	Yes	Yes	NA	NA
	AKI/AKD/CKD	Yes	Yes	NA	NA

AKI, acute kidney disease; AKD, acute kidney injury; CKD, chronic kidney disease; GFR, glomerular filtration rate in mL/min/1.73 m²; GFR, general population; CRP, kidney replacement therapy; NA, not applicable; Yes, applicable.

Markers of kidney damage include albuminuria, urine abnormalities, imaging abnormalities, pathologic abnormalities, and electrolyte disorders due to altered tubular function. Only albuminuria, urine dipstick, and urine microscopy are included in this chapter.

Table_23_1

Day	P _{marker}	eGFR
0	1.0	135
1.5	1.6	79
2.0	1.8	69
2.5	1.9	65
3.0	2.0	60

Fig. 23.2 Effect of an acute GFR decline on generation, filtration, excretion, balance, plasma concentration of an endogenous filtration marker (P_{marker}), and estimated GFR ($eGFR$) based on the marker. After an acute GFR decline, generation of the marker is unchanged, but filtration and excretion are reduced, resulting in retention of the marker (a rising positive balance), a rising plasma concentration, and declining eGFR (non-steady state). During this time, the plasma concentration leads to an increase in filtered load (the product of GFR times the plasma level) until filtration equals generation. At that time, cumulative balance and the plasma level plateau at a new steady state. In the new steady state, eGFR approximates mGFR. GFR is expressed in units of milliliter per minute per 1.73 m². Tubular secretion and reabsorption and extrarenal elimination are assumed to be zero. (Permission granted from J Am Soc Nephrol for Stevens LA, Levey AS. Measured GFR as a confirmatory test for estimated GFR. J Am Soc Nephrol. 2009;20(11):2305–2313.)

Fig_23_2

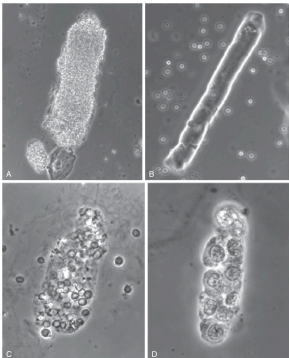


Fig. 23.5 Urinary casts. (A) Finely granular cast. (B) Waxy cast with the typical "melted wax" appearance. (C) Red blood cell cast. (D) Renal tubule epithelial cell cast. (From Stevens LA, Nolin TD, Richardson MM, et al. Comparison of drug dosing recommendations based on measured GFR and kidney function estimating equations. *Am J Kidney Dis*. 2009;54:33-42.)

Fig_23_5

Use	eGFR ^a	eGFR _{cre} ^b
Nondietary state (AKI)	Change in eGFR lags behind the change in mGFR (eGFR overestimates mGFR when mGFR is declining and underestimates mGFR when mGFR is rising)	Change in eGFR lags behind the change in mGFR (eGFR overestimates mGFR when mGFR is declining and underestimates mGFR when mGFR is rising)
Factors affecting generation ^c	Decreased by large muscle mass, high protein diet, ingestion of cooked meat, and creatine supplements Increased by small muscle mass, limb amputation, muscle-wasting diseases	Presumed decreased in greater adiposity, smoking, hyperthyroidism, glucocorticoid excess, and chronic inflammation, as indicated by insulin resistance, high levels of C-reactive protein and tumor necrosis factor, or low levels of serum albumin Presumed increased in hypothyroidism NA
Factors affecting tubular reabsorption or secretion ^d	Decreased by drug-induced inhibition of secretion	Decreased by large losses of extracellular fluid (drainage of pleural fluid or ascites)
Factors affecting extrarenal elimination ^e	Decreased by inhibition of gut creatininemia by antibiotics increased by dialysis, large losses of extracellular fluid (drainage of pleural fluid or ascites)	Increased by large losses of extracellular fluid (drainage of pleural fluid or ascites)
Range	Less precise at higher GFR due to higher biological variability in non-GFR determinants relative to GFR and larger measurement error in Scr and GFR	Less precise at higher GFR, due to higher biological variability in non-GFR determinants relative to GFR, and larger measurement error in Scys and GFR
Interference with assays	Spectral interferences (bilirubin, some drugs) Chemical interferences (glucose, ketones, bilirubin, some drugs)	At high levels, may be susceptible to hook effects

^aeGFRs eGFR, opposite effects on serum creatinine and serum cystatin C.

^bGeneration, tubular reabsorption and secretion, and extrarenal elimination are non-GFR determinants. Errors in eGFR_{cre}-cys related to non-GFR determinants of creatinine or cystatin C hypothesized to be less than for mGFR and eGFR_{cys} alone.

^cAKI, Acute kidney injury; eGFR_{cre}, glomerular filtration rate estimates based on serum creatinine; eGFR_{cys}, glomerular filtration rate estimates based on cystatin C; GFR, glomerular filtration rate; mGFR, measured glomerular filtration rate; Scr, serum creatinine; Scys, serum cystatin C.

Table_23_2

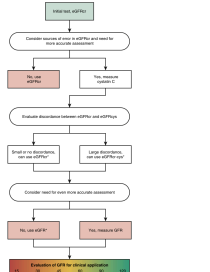


Fig. 3.3 *Overturner: Relative noise of GPR evaluation using self and supervised learning*. The figure shows the relative noise of GPR evaluation for different methods. The y-axis is 'Relative noise' (0 to 1) and the x-axis is 'Method' (Self, Supervised, Unsupervised). The 'Self' method has a relative noise of 1.0. The 'Supervised' method has a relative noise of approximately 0.2. The 'Unsupervised' method has a relative noise of approximately 0.8. The 'Supervised' method is significantly lower than the 'Self' and 'Unsupervised' methods.

Fig_23_3

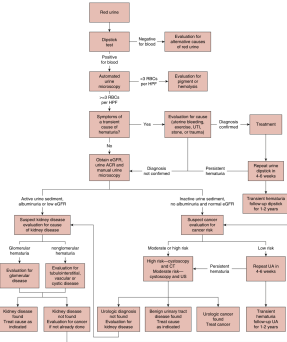


Fig. 20.6 Evaluation of hematuria. The algorithm describes our approach to the evaluation of hematuria. Hematuria should first be confirmed via dipstick and automated urine microscopy, followed by evaluation for traumatic causes of hematuria (such as urinary bleeding, exercise, or very recent infection, stone, or trauma). The patient should then receive a tripartite evaluation for kidney disease, followed by risk stratification. Evaluation for bladder cancer and urologic causes of hematuria. High-risk patients are 240 years old and have >300-300/sq microscopic history <25 red blood cells/HPF on a single urine microscopy, or history of gross hematuria. Moderate-risk patients are women 50–59 years old, men 40–49 years old, people with a 10–300-300/sq history of smudging, those with 11 to 25 RBC/HPF on a single urine microscopy, and other relevant history. Negative workups for cancer or urologic disease should prompt a formal workup for kidney disease and vice versa.

Fig_23_6

[illegible]

Table_23_3

Table 23.4

Kidney disease: Improving global outcomes (KDIGO) guideline: categories of proteinuria

	Normal to mildly increased (A1)	Moderately increased (A2)	Severely increased (A3)
Timed urine collection			
AER (mg/24h)	<30	30-300	>300
PER (mg/24h)	<150	150-500	>500
Spot or timed collection			
ACR:			
mg/mmol	<3	3-30	>30
mg/g	<30	30-300	>300
PCR:			
mg/mmol	<15	15-50	>50
mg/g	<150	150-500	>500
Protein reagent strip	Negative to trace	Trace to +	+ or greater

Relationships between AER and ACR and between PER and PCR are based on the assumption that average creatinine excretion rate is 1.0 g/day or 10 mmol/day (conversions are rounded for pragmatic reasons). ACR and PCR may also be reported as $\mu\text{g}/\text{mg}$ (1 $\mu\text{g}/\text{mg}$ = 1 mg/g) or mg/mg (1 mg/mg = 0.001 mg/g).

ACR, Albumin-to-creatinine ratio; AER, albumin excretion rate; PCR, protein-to-creatinine ratio; PER, protein excretion rate.

From Kidney Disease: Improving Global Outcomes (KDIGO) CKD Work Group. KDIGO 2012 clinical practice guideline for the evaluation and management of chronic kidney disease. *Kidney Int Suppl.* 2013;3:1–150.

Table 23.5

Evaluation of proteinuria in adults

Initial testing of proteinuria (in descending order of preference, in all cases an early morning urine sample is preferred)
• Urine albumin-to-creatinine ratio (ACR)
• Urine protein-to-creatinine ratio (PCR)
• Reagent strip urinalysis for total protein with automated reading
• Reagent strip urinalysis for total protein with manual reading
Confirmatory testing for proteinuria
• Confirm reagent strip positive albuminuria and proteinuria by quantitative laboratory measurement and express as a ratio to creatinine wherever possible.
• Confirm ACR ≥ 30 mg/g on a random untimed urine with a subsequent early morning urine sample.
• If a more accurate estimate of albuminuria or total proteinuria is required, measure AER or PER in a timed urine sample

Clinical laboratory reporting of ACR and PCR in untimed urine samples in addition to albumin concentration or proteinuria concentrations rather than concentrations alone.

From Kidney Disease: Improving Global Outcomes (KDIGO) CKD Work Group. KDIGO 2012 clinical practice guideline for the evaluation and management of chronic kidney disease. *Kidney Int Suppl.* 2013;3:1–150.

Table 23.6

Biological, preanalytical, and analytical factors that may impact variability in urinary protein or albumin or ACR

Biological	
Increase in albumin or protein	Hematuria High-intensity exercise Uterine bleeding
Increase in protein	Posture (postural proteinuria)
Increase in ACR or PCR due to lower urine creatinine	Urinary tract infection or inflammation Older age Female sex Reduced muscle mass Decreased dietary protein intake Decreased physical activity
Preanalytical	
Collection type	Timed or untimed (spot)
Time of day	First morning vs. random void (first morning reduces variation)
Storage conditions	Degradation of protein or albumin during storage Adsorption to plastic Storage temperature
Analytical	
Total protein or albumin measurement High albumin levels can result in high-dose hook effect	

Adapted from Johnson DW, Jones GR, Mahew TH, et al. Chronic kidney disease and measurement of albuminuria or proteinuria: a position statement. *Med J Aust.* 2012;197:254–255; and Miller WG, Bruns DE, Horih GL, et al. Current issues in measurement and reporting of urinary albumin excretion [article in French]. *Ann Biol Clin (Paris).* 2011;68:9–25.

Table_23_4

Table_23_5

Table_23_6

Table 23.7

Main causes of abnormal color changes in urine

	Cause	Color
Pathologic conditions	Macroscopic hematuria, hemoglobinuria, myoglobinuria	Pink, red, brown, black
	Jaundice	Yellow to brown
	Chyluria	White milky
	Massive uric acid crystalluria	Pink
	Porphyria, alkaptonuria	Red to black; increases after urine left to stand
Medications	Rifampin	Yellow-orange to red
	Propofol	White
	Phenothiazine, phenazopyridine	Red
	Chloroquine, nitrofurantoin	Brown
	Triamterene, blue dyes of enteral feeds	Green
Foods	Metronidazole, methyldopa, imipenem-cilastatin	Darkening after urine left to stand
	Beetroot	Red
	Senna rhubarb	Yellow to brown-red

From Fogazzi GB, Verdesca S, Garigali G. Urinalysis: core curriculum 2008. *Am J Kidney Dis.* 2008;51:1052–1067; and Davison A. *Urinalysis*. 3rd ed. Oxford: Oxford University Press; 2005.

Table 23.8

Causes of hematuria

Location in the urinary tract	Clinical entity	Urine microscopy findings				
		RBC casts or dysmorphic RBCs	WBC	Crystals	Albuminuria	Symptoms
Kidney	Primary glomerular disease (e.g., Alport syndrome, IgA, C3, and dense deposit disease)	+	–	–	±	–
	Secondary glomerular disease (e.g., lupus glomerulonephritis, vasculitis, and postinfectious glomerulonephritis)	–	+	–	+	+
Tubules, interstitium, vessels, cysts	Papillary necrosis	–	±	–	±	+
	Sickle cell disease	–	±	–	±	±
Upper urinary tract	Autosomal dominant polycystic kidney disease	–	–	–	–	–
	Infarct (thrombosis, embolism, dissection)	–	±	–	±	±
Lower urinary tract	Bleeding kidney masses	–	–	–	–	–
	Malignancy	–	±	–	±	±
Any region of the urinary tract	Pyelonephritis	–	+	–	–	+
	Nephrolithiasis	–	–	–	–	–
Any region of the urinary tract	Malignancy (bladder, ureter, prostate)	–	±	–	–	±
	Ureterolithiasis	–	+	–	–	±
Any region of the urinary tract	UTI	–	–	–	–	±
	Urinary tract infection	–	+	–	–	+
Any region of the urinary tract	Exercise hematuria	–	–	–	–	–
	Bleeding diathesis or anticoagulation	–	–	–	–	–
Any region of the urinary tract	Hypertension and hyperuricemia	–	±	±	–	–
	Drugs (cytotoxic/chemotherapy or crystal-inducing drugs)	–	–	–	–	±
Any region of the urinary tract	Trauma	–	–	–	–	+

D, Dysmorphic; I, isomorphic; +, almost always present; ±, sometimes present; –, rarely present.

Table 23.9

Common casts

Cast	Main clinical association(s)
Hyaline	Normal and in kidney disease
Fine granular	Normal and in kidney disease; casts contain protein aggregates
Coarse granular	Kidney disease of any cause; casts contain degenerated cellular elements
Waxy	Kidney disease of any cause; casts result from degeneration of other casts
Broad	Chronic kidney disease; casts reflect hypertrophy of the tubule
Fatty	Kidney disease with heavy proteinuria
Red blood cell	Proliferative glomerulonephritis; casts result from glomerular bleeding
White blood cell	Inflammatory tubulointerstitial disease
Tubular epithelial cell	Often the result of active acute kidney diseases such as acute tubular necrosis, proliferative glomerulonephritis, acute interstitial nephritis, thrombotic microangiopathy; casts formed from the aggregation of desquamated cells of the tubule

From Fogazzi GB, Verdesca S, Garigali G. Urinalysis: core curriculum 2008. *Am J Kidney Dis.* 2008;51:1052–1067.

Table_23_7

Table_23_8

Table_23_9

Table 23.10

Common crystals and their appearance

Crystal	Appearance	pH range	Birefringence
Endogenous			
Ammonium biurate	Yellow-brown spheres with spicules, from apples	5.5–7.0	Strong
Bilirubin crystals	Yellow needles like crystals, attach to cell surfaces	5.5	Weak
Calcium carbonate	Dumbbells, thick rods, 4-lip clover	7.0	Strong
Calcium oxalate	Monohydrate: colorless oval, dumbbells, rods Dihydrate: colorless bipyramidal	5.4–6.7	Weak
Calcium phosphate	Prisms, sticks, needles, stars, needles in isolation or in aggregates	6.7–7.0	Strong
Cholesterol	The plates with well-defined edges	5.5	Negative
Cystine	Colorless hexagonal plates with irregular sides	5.5	Weak
2,8-Dihydroxyadenine	Rectangular round with central notches and dark outline	5.5–7.0	Malesse cross
Leucine	Yellow-brown spheres with concentric striations	5.5–6.5	Malesse cross
Tyrosine	Colorless to yellow thin needles in bundles or rosettes	5.5–6.5	Strong
Triple phosphate (struvite)	Trapezoids, prisms, leather-like, "coffin-lid"	6.2–7.0	Strong
Drug-related			
Acetazolamide	Thin needles with sharp or blunt ends	5.5–7.0	Strong
Amoxicillin	Colorless thin needles, isomorphous-like	5.5–6.5	Strong
Allopurinol	Thin needles in isolation or as aggregates	6.0–7.0	Strong
Ciprofloxacin	Colorless needles, stars, fans, rhombs	7–9	Strong
Methicillin	Yellow-brown spheres with concentric striations	5.4–6.0	Strong
Sulfadiazine	Amorphous or shaggy or sheaves of wheat, shells	5.5	Strong
Triamterene	Brown and other colors (green/orange/red); spheres	5.5	Malesse cross
Vitamin C (ascorbic acid)	Same as for monohydrated calcium oxalate	5.4–6.7	Strong

From Cainesworth G, Parazola MA. Urine sediment examination in the diagnosis and management of kidney disease: core curriculum 2010. *Am J Kidney Dis.* 2010;70:229–272.

"microalbuminuria" or "clinical proteinuria," referring to dipstick-positive proteinuria, approximately equivalent to A3, are no longer recommended. Nephrotic-range proteinuria refers to protein excretion of ≥ 3.5 g/24 hours. Nephrotic syndrome is defined as urine total protein excretion ≥ 3000 or ≥ 5500 mg/day, hypoalbuminemia, hyperlipidemia, and edema.

Table_23_10

Table 23.11

Use of laboratory assessment in diagnosis of cause of kidney disease

Kidney parenchymal involvement	Presence of "active disease" on pathologic examination (examples below)	GFR	Proteinuria	Dipstick	Possible microscopy findings
None	No	NA	A1	None	Dysmorphic RBC, RBC casts, RTE, granular casts
Glomerular diseases	Yes (proliferative)	NA	A3 may be nephrotic range	None	Liquid, RTE, granular casts
	No	NA	A2 may be nephrotic range	None	Liquid, RTE, granular casts
Tubulointerstitial disease	Yes (inflammatory)	NA	A2/A3 (may have nonalbumin proteinuria)	Leukocyte esterase	WBC and WBC casts, non-nephrotic RBC, RTE, granular casts
	No	NA	A1/A2 (may have nonalbumin proteinuria)	May have blebs in urine concentration and acidification	RTE, granular casts
Vascular diseases	Yes (thrombotic microangiopathy)	NA	A2/A3	None	Nephrotic RBC, RTE, granular casts, RTE, granular casts
Other	No	NA	A1/A2	None	RTE, granular casts

None includes decreased kidney perfusion or acute obstruction. Nonproliferative glomerular diseases include diabetic nephropathy, podocytopathies, and membranous nephropathy. Inflammatory tubulointerstitial diseases include kidney diseases associated with urinary tract disorders including infection, stones, and chronic obstruction. Other refers to diseases that may affect any location in the kidney parenchyma, such as cystic kidney diseases or congenital anomalies of the kidney and urinary tract (CAKUT). Genetic diseases are not considered a separate category because diseases in each category are now recognized as having genetic determinants. Drug toxicity is not considered a separate category but can affect all locations in the kidney parenchyma. Pathologic findings in kidney transplant recipients are not fundamentally different from those in native kidney disease, except for the occurrence of acute and chronic tubulointerstitial and vascular rejection.

NA, Not applicable as level of GFR is generally not helpful in ascertaining cause of disease. Exceptions include minimal change disease, in which GFR is normal, and acute tubular necrosis and tubulointerstitial transplant rejection, in which GFR is reduced. Proteinuria, dipstick, and microscopy categories reflect how best to group individual patients may not fit into these categories. A1, A2, and A3 categories for albuminuria. RBC, Red blood cell; RTE, renal tubular epithelial cell; WBC, White blood cell.

Table_23_11